

Nikhil Rao

CONTACT

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EMPLOYMENT **Postdoctoral Fellow**, National Bureau of Economic Research 2025–Present

EDUCATION **Ph.D., Economics**, University of Michigan 2025
 M.A., Economics, University of Michigan 2021
 B.A., Economics & Mathematics, University of Massachusetts Amherst 2015

FIELDS Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS **“Measuring Discrimination using Natural Experiments”**, with James Reeves.

IN PROGRESS **“Using Network Data to Measure Social Returns and Improve Targeting of Crime-Reduction Interventions”**, with Ashley Craig, Sara Heller, and Kenneth Hofmeister.
 “The Socioeconomic Consequences of Misdemeanor Conviction”, with James Reeves.
 “Peer Socioeconomic Mismatch and Student Achievement”, with Micah Y. Baum.
 “Parental Resources and College Major Choice”, with Zsigmond Pálvölgyi & Tyler Radler.
 “Examining Interventions to Improve Outcomes of Justice-involved Individuals”, with James Reeves.

PUBLICATIONS **“Inflation Expectations and Nonlinearities in the Phillips Curve”**, with Alexander Doser, Ricardo Nunes and Viacheslav Sheremirov. *Journal of Applied Econometrics* 38:4 (2023), 453–471.
 “Sectoral inflation and the Phillips curve: What has changed since the Great Recession?”, with Maria Jose Luengo-Prado and Viacheslav Sheremirov. *Economics Letters* 172 (2018), 63–68.

EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS **2026**
 (*including upcoming*)
 Federal Reserve Bank of Boston Boston, MA

 2025
 Tufts University Brownbag Medford, MA
 Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars Philadelphia, PA
 University of Colorado Denver, CO

 2024
 Southern Economic Association Meeting Washington, DC
 Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management Fall Conference National Harbor, MD
 Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime Zurich, Switzerland
 Western Economic Association Conference Seattle, WA
 Texas Economics of Crime Workshop Austin, TX

 2019
 Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting Lansing, MI

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	Policy Impacts Early Career Scholars Grant	2026
	Department of Economics Fellowship	2025
	Rackham One Term Dissertation Fellowship	2024
	Rackham Conference Travel Grant	2024 (x2)
	Department of Economics Conference Travel Grant	2019; 2024 (x2)
	Poverty Solutions One Term Fellowship	2023
	Department of Economics Research Grant	2022; 2023
	Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship	2018–2019
TEACHING	University of Michigan	
	Economics of the Population (ECON 466)	Fall 2020
	Introductory Macroeconomics (ECON 102)	Winter 2020
	Introductory Microeconomics (ECON 101)	Fall 2019
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE & EMPLOYMENT	University of Michigan	
	Graduate Research Assistant to Ashley Craig & Sara Heller	2020–2024
	Summer Research Assistant to Ana Reynoso	2020
	Summer Research Assistant to Lauren Falcao Bergquist	2019
	Federal Reserve Bank of Boston	
	Senior Research Assistant, Jenny Tang & Viacheslav Sheremirov	2015–2018
SERVICE	Referee: <i>American Law and Economics Review</i> , <i>Journal of Human Resources</i>	
	Graduate Program Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2021–2022
	Admissions Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2020–2021
	Social Chair, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2019–2020
OTHER	Analytics and Programming: Stata, R, Matlab and $\text{\LaTeX}$	
	Clearance: U.S. Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status	
	Citizenship: USA	
REFERENCES	Sara Heller Associate Professor Department of Economics University of Michigan sbheller@umich.edu	Basit Zafar Professor Department of Economics University of Michigan bzafar@umich.edu
	Michael Mueller-Smith Associate Professor Department of Economics University of Michigan mgms@umich.edu	Ashley Craig Senior Lecturer Research School of Economics Australian National University ashley.craig@anu.edu.au